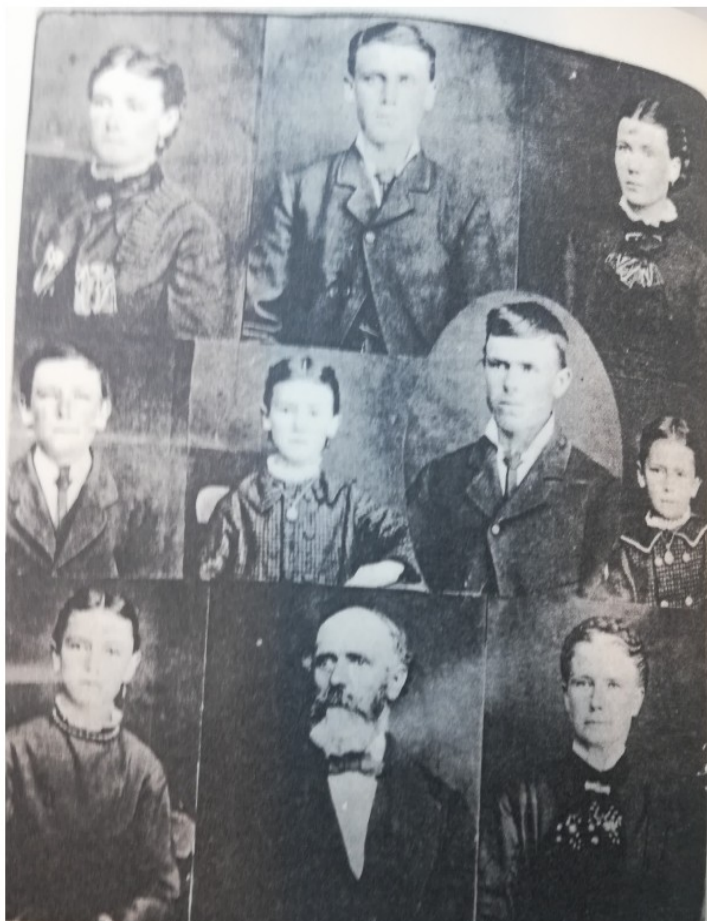
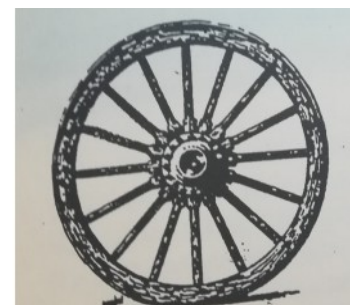




HENRY AND MARY ANN LUNT FAMILY

Martha Henrietta Henry Whittaker Ellen Eva
 William Wilson Violet Wilson Randle Wilson Alice Maude
 Florence Lunt **Henry Lunt** **Mary Ann Wilson Lunt**
 Photo from Lehi F. Hintze



CHAPTER XXVI

LIFE IN PACHECO

1890 – 1894

Colonia Pacheco was one of the mountain colonies in Mexico named in honor of a famous Mexican general. The settlement was established in the top of the Sierra Madre range, nearly seven thousand feet above sea level. It occupied a picturesque spot in a little valley known as the Corrales Basin. The irrigable land was not extensive, but the timber was abundant. It appeared to be a good place for raising cattle, but it was obvious that the land could not support a very large population.¹ The forests were alive with wild game of all varieties – deer, turkeys, bears, and cougars – and the streams were teeming with fish. One of the girls who lived in Pacheco, Marie A. Porter Hardy, wrote: “The grass was so tall, it looked like the Garden of Eden. There were many snakes. The men never went into the mountains without a gun, it was dangerous with the Indians and Mexicans and the wild animals, mountain lions and all. The men always carried a pistol in their back pocket. In the summer we had about six weeks of heat, maybe up to a hundred [degrees]. Then the summer rains would come. My, how it would rain.”²

Before the Lunt family reached Pacheco, they stayed in Colonia Diaz about a month during the Christmas and New Years celebration. Thomas wrote about this, also some reflections on living in Mexico:

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We all attended the program presented by the Diaz ward. These doings we found to be very nice; however, on seeing the Mexican flag raised, which was the Mexican custom at Christmas time, our spirits dropped. It [the flag] looked like a mighty poor substitute for the stars and stripes. Although, as the years went by, we became accustomed to seeing the red, white and green with the eagle in the center--and it didn't look as bad as at first, still it never was a match for 'old glory.' My mind harkened back to the good old days in the land and town of my nativity when on Independence Day morn I watched Old Glory hoisted atop the two-piece liberty pole as the band peeled forth the *Star Spangled Banner*.

The total absence of old Santa too served not a little to dampen our spirits. However, we were cheered some on Christmas Eve by a bunch with harmonicas and the like serenading us in the wee hours of the morning.

During our month's stay at Diaz, we had to herd our stock every day and corral them at night. The valley was mostly covered with what they called Sacaton, meaning giant grass. This grass stood in some places above a man's head sitting on a horse, but it contained no more nourishment than wood. If it had not been for some brouse and a scanty bit of other grasses among the mesquite here and there, the stock would have starved to death.³

When the Lunt family arrived in Pacheco they built a temporary shelter and began cutting logs, building fences and planting. A man who was leaving to bring his family back from Gila Valley, Arizona, offered his cabin to Henry Lunt while he was away. This made it handy for the family to get the planting done. The boys, in addition to planting, cut house logs and began laying them. They fenced, worked out the family's assessment on the town ditch and helped build the

log school house. Broughton wrote: "We all went forth with enthusiasm at our new task of fencing land, digging stumps, building houses, making corrals etc. While George (15) and Oscar (18) were building big log houses, Tom, Edgerton and I were cutting smaller trees our size and making chicken coops and calf pens." Annie and her children remained there until their own cabin was built. Henry was afflicted with a severe "spell of the grippe," and Annie, who was especially good at nursing, was able to make him more comfortable in the cabin. She nursed him back to health within a few weeks.

For entertainment they did a lot of dancing and singing. Every time a new house was finished, a dance was held at that home. Thomas wrote that John T. Whetten, the fiddler, was the best and most musical musician he had ever heard. "When he wielded the downward sweep with his violin bow, singing out simultaneously 'circle all', one just had to dance whether he was physically fit or not. A common gossip was to the effect that Mr. Whetten could play, call, and trade horses at the same time."

The Mexican colonies were chosen, in part, because they were out of the way. Polygamous husbands sought to find locations for their families unlikely to be "raided" by federal deputies. Obviously, in such areas the opportunities for an economic livelihood were not particularly good. The women shared with the men in the hardships of the mountain life. They lived a life of toil and struggle and were deprived of even the bare necessities. The L.D.S. Church continued to make efforts to make some compromise with the U. S. Federal Government, but to no avail. President Wilford Woodruff concluded his journal, of the year 1889, by writing the following:

This ends the year. The word of the Prophet, Joseph Smith, has been fulfilled wherein he declared that the whole nation would turn against Zion and make war upon the Saints. The nation has never been so full of lies against the Saints as it is today.⁴

The year 1890 saw a continuation of the bitter struggle for political supremacy in Salt Lake City by the federal government in order

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to control the Church. The political success of the Liberal party at this time gave strength to its efforts to secure more adverse legislation for Utah. The Cullom Bill was proposed in pursuance of the wishes of the anti-Mormons. If passed, it would have taken practically all of the political and material rights from the Latter-day Saints.

President Woodruff's eighty-third birthday was on March 1, 1890. The aged president had been a member of the church almost from its birth. He had seen the Mormons driven in ever-larger groups from Missouri, Ohio, and Illinois to the Great Basin. Now he was seeing thousands of saints being forced to move from their homes because of federal oppression due to polygamy. For several months he "wrestled mightily with the Lord." On September 25, 1890, he wrote in his journal: "I have arrived at a point in the history of my life as the president of the Church where I am under the necessity of acting for the temporal salvation of the church." On that date President Woodruff issued the official declaration which proclaimed the end of polygamy among the Mormons. The "Manifesto" was sustained in the October church conference. In that conference Pres. Woodruff said:

I want to say to all Israel that the step which I have taken in issuing this manifesto has not been done without earnest prayer before the Lord...I am not ignorant of the feelings that have been engendered through the course I have pursued....The Lord will never permit me or any other man who stands as the President of this Church to lead you astray. It is not in the program. It is not in the mind of God. If I were to attempt that, the Lord would move me out of my place.⁵

The manifesto resulted in a noticeable change in attitude toward the Church. President Harrison issued a proclamation of amnesty on January 4, 1893, to those who had entered into polygamous marriages prior to November 1, 1890. The restrictions against voters were removed, and in 1893 the property which belonged to the Church was returned. Three years later, when Utah achieved Statehood, the real

estate which had been confiscated was likewise returned to the Church. The manifesto did not announce that polygamous living would be discontinued; it simply said that no more plural marriages would be sanctioned. Everyone understood that the stipulations of the manifesto would take time—that the cessation of polygamous living and the separation of church and state, and of church and the economy, would not occur overnight. The national political leaders had made it clear, however, that it must occur, sooner or later.

The Manifesto and the subsequent political changes happened too late to affect the Lunt family. Had it taken place several years sooner, Henry Lunt and his families would not have gone to Mexico, or would have returned. But, by the time the government had released the Mormon polygamists from prison and statehood had occurred, the Lunts were well established in Mexico and had accepted their situation. They had acquired property and were settled into a way of life that would have been difficult to change. Although the colonists were grateful for Mexico, their land of refuge, most of them never gave up the idea of some day returning to their native country, the United States of America.

That first summer in Pacheco the Lunt family managed to produce some corn and potatoes, as well as a few vegetables to replenish their depleted food supply. But they did not have enough to carry them over until another harvest. It was a challenge to keep food on the table for the family. There were plenty of deer in the mountains, so they always had meat, but they missed the vegetables and flour products that they needed so much. The children went to school for a few weeks during the winter, but they learned about hard work and became very resourceful in other ways. Although they were isolated from the natives, they still worked at learning Spanish. Annie and Sarah braided and made straw hats and taught this art to the family. They learned several types of braiding and made whips, quirts and the like, with fancy braided knots on the ends.

In 1891, John W. Young, a man with good intentions known as a "wild catter," undertook to build a railroad into the Colonies. The people had great faith in him and every available man and team turned out to work for him. He barely paid the men enough to pay for horse

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feed and a scant living while they worked. When the railroad failed, the project became known as the "Manana Railroad."

The Lunt family managed through the summer and winter of 1890 on rather slim rations hoping to grow a more bounteous crop during the next summer. They had raised a good crop of potatoes--Thomas wrote the following about Ege hauling potatoes to Chihuahua the following spring [1891] while he and Broughton went with their father, Henry, to Deming, New Mexico, a distance of 210 miles, to get some clothes and other necessities:

We brought with us two teams to take an extra wagon home. The customs officials gave the menfolk no little annoyance with their suspicions that we were trying to smuggle something in. Father managed to get by without any serious trouble. On our arrival home, we jumped into the planting of crops for it was already in the season. The burden of the farm work fell upon me. Oscar was working at the sawmill much of the time to pay for the lumber used in our cabins, as well as a lot more with which to build a barn. George had gone for the summer on the John W. Young railroad which was being built but never was finished. Ege was hired by one, Franklin D. Spencer, to herd dairy cows all summer. Old faithful Broughton was my shadow as usual.

There were frequent electrical storms and a big flood carried Moses Thatcher's sawmill down the river. John Campbell, the operator, soon salvaged the machinery and rebuilt the mill and had it running again. The colony depended on the mill to saw up the lumber, make shingles and lath. They were capable of turning out most anything needed in the line of wood materials for building purposes.

The lumber business became almost more lucrative than the cattle business and farming. What lumber and shingles, which were not used for houses, were freighted in wagons to the colonies below the mountains, or were hauled to Pearson to be shipped out of the country

From the railroad station near Colonia Juarez. This was a difficult journey, owing to the mountainous character of the road and the exposure to all kinds of weather. The lumber had to be freighted down the steep winding canyon road which was in the top of the mountains, and then over terrain that today would seem impassable. It was necessary to haul all the flour and merchandise consumed by the settlers, back up this same dangerous road.

In the fall of 1891 a party of U. S. Scientists came through the community. School was let out for the occasion. They had 30 pack mules. Henry had them take photographs of the family.



**THE FAMILY LOG HOME
PACHECO, MEXICO**

1891

(L To R) Rachel, Ann Gower Lunt, Ellen, Parley L., Thomas, Broughton, Edgerton (Age 12 – Sarah's oldest), Edward, Heaton, Henry Lunt holding Alma (Born April 24, 1890 in Mexico), George A. (With the gun), and Oscar (Age 21). George made the identification on this picture.

Photograph from Sarah L. McGuire, Silver City, New Mexico

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Sunday, February 4, 1892, was the concluding day of a four-day conference held in Colonia Juarez. At this conference, Apostle George Teasdale, President of the Mexican Mission, chose the leaders of the new mission. He appointed Alex F. Macdonald and Henry Eyring as his counselors. John M. Macfarlane was picked as a member of the High Council. Henry Lunt was named as Patriarch.⁶

Due to the fact that Henry's first wife, Ellen, was leaving for Mexico, Mary Ann Lunt replaced her as Stake Relief Society President in Cedar City on February 5, 1892. Sage T. Jones and Anna C. Ward were put in as Counselors. Ellen came on the train to Mexico early in 1892 traveling with an adopted girl named Maggy Hunter. Henry and Sarah went to Deming to meet them. It was necessary for them to stay there a few days because the girl, Maggy, was extremely sick and was diagnosed as having diphtheria. She died there and all her clothes and bedding were burned, as specified by law.⁷ They must have buried her there, before returning to Pacheco.

Things went well for the family until the season of 1892. They had great hopes of raising more crops and had cleared the ground and planted several acres of corn and potatoes. But they soon found that their hopes were in vain. Thomas wrote:

We had a killing frost up to June 10 [1892], barely missed the freezing point in July, had a slight nip on August 4 and then the morning of September 11, all vegetation was laid low. The rainy season was so late that year that the dairy cows were not rounded up until early August. The wheat crop in the lower valleys was light, but still lighter than unlucky season. And this was the same with the other crops. Then, all of a sudden from the ground all around the neighborhood, mushrooms sprang up. The cows would make a run for them immediately on being let out of the corral following the milking, eating them in preference to the grass. This welcome harvest continued on for weeks. We eagerly gathered them in

and they were cooked in every way the women could contrive. Thus the day was saved. This event was no less miraculous than the 'manna' of ancient Israel.

Broughton wrote that the year of 1892 was a most desperate one, flour was not to be bought. The cattle were dying of starvation but they were able to save their corn and had it made into meal. He recorded the following:

The year of 1892 was a very severe drought year all over the west and food became very scarce, especially bread stuff. Also it was an early fall and the corn did not mature--what had been planted in Pacheco, naturally being a high altitude, had a short season. Father, Tom and I hoed corn, the only means of cultivation we had because the only good team of mares we had reached Mexico with had to be sold to make ends meet. The older mares had become so weak and poor that, after the corn was planted, they did well to live and suckle colts, which were always killed by the mountain lions before the season was over. We hoed constantly. Father had to be nearby so we could tell him which was corn and which were weeds.

Through our constant hoeing of the corn we saved all the moisture for the corn, it matured while everyone else's got frozen and was not fit for human consumption. During this time, many more people reached the Colonies. Some were very destitute and people were obliged to use corn meal for bread. In Pacheco we were the only ones who had corn. I well remember how people came to borrow the corn or meal, not knowing how or when they could ever return it. I can hear yet the conversations that took place when our last sack was being dipped into. People would come to Father and say, 'Brother Lunt,

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have you any more meal you could lend me, my family hasn't a dust of bread stuff in the house.' Father's reply would be, 'Ah, dear brother, you will have to see Sarah.' I have heard Mother bear her testimony many times to the fact that she divided down to the last mixing and trusted in the Lord that some how the way would open that she could feed her own.⁸

Henry tried to encourage the people. He gave them his corn and helped them survive until the spring of 1893. At this time, Charles Humphrey came and offered a milk cow for enough corn to make one more meal for his family. Brother Lunt said, "No, I will not take your cow. You need her more than I do. I will lend you corn for two meals which is one-half of what I have left. Then, I pray the Lord will provide for us all as He has in the past." That next day the Lunt family fasted and prayed, as there was no more corn meal left in Colonia Pacheco or Corrales. Broughton wrote:

Just at that point when the last dust had been divided, here came Albert Farnsworth with two four-horse loads of flour. By night mother [Sarah] testifies that she had 1000 pounds of flour in her house that had been returned for corn meal.

The church at headquarters had been in touch with the Colonies and had heard of their desperate conditions. They sent two carloads of flour to the Mexican Colonies from Mesa, Arizona.

Thomas compared the situation to the famine in the scriptures. He wrote: "Our place became known as the Egypt of the Colonies. Men came as far as a hundred miles to buy corn from father." Everyone became very tired of eating cornbread. He wrote: "corn bread was not only distasteful but proved injurious to some, especially our dear mother [Annie]." Annie's digestive system simply could not tolerate the rough corn meal. This story was published in the L.D.S. magazine, *The Children's Friend*, in November, 1953. Parley was only ten years old when this occurred but he recalled that after the

flour came in from Deming, "you never saw such tickled kids in your life. We were going around eating the flour as if it were cake. The corn bread, without any salt or soda, was just like hardpan."

Broughton wrote the following about his father, Henry, and his brother, Parley:

Father always took one day off each week for letter writing. He couldn't read what he wrote after writing but, by having very heavy lines drawn on the paper, could follow them. Parley herded the cows to be sure they would find the best pastures and he brought them safely to the corral each night so we could obtain the scanty supply of milk they gave, and also that the calves might be more safe from ravaging wild beasts that roamed the woods. One day while herding cows he was bitten by a black rattler on the little toe. His leg swelled up so tight we were afraid it would burst. We did all we knew for it, but to no avail until the Lord heard our feeble cry and answered our prayers.

In the fall of 1892 Henry and part of the family went to conference in Colonia Juarez. Thomas wrote:

I drove the sorrel mares, Mag and Pete, on this trip in the autumn of 1892. Our conference-going party included father, mother [Annie], Aunt Ellen, sisters Ellen and Rachel, and myself. We made the drive very nicely in a day, arriving in Juarez early. It was the first successful fruit season for Juarez and a very fine display of apples, peaches, pears, plums, grapes, and melons were exhibited at the Primary Association's Fair which was held during the conference. We got to sample these fruits and it was a rare treat. This was the only conference that mother ever attended in that land. Her poor health rendered it impossible for her to make such a trip thereafter. [Apparently the fruit did

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well in spite of the drought in Pacheco. They probably were able to irrigate their crops; and, being at a much lower elevation, nothing would have frozen.]

When we were making preparations for our return home, the team had to be shod. Alma Spillsbury had promised father he would attend to it, but he had only tacked one shoe on when he began complaining that he really did not have time, so I told him I thought I could do the job. I had just finished when father came along and asked if the shoeing was done. I told him yes but that I had to do it myself. On close examination of the job, father said he was well pleased and surprised that I had done such a fine job. [Thomas was 14 ½ years old].

One of Henry and Anne Gower Lunt's grandchildren, Fern Guymon Bauer, wrote the following about Annie (as she was called):

In Mexico, one day grandma was up in the attic making the beds and one of the boards flipped up, not being nailed down, and she fell through, injuring her back. This left her an invalid for the rest of her life. She could walk but could never stoop over. She had a pair of tongs to pick things up off the floor. They were a very humble group of people that lived in Pacheco--no doctors, just a midwife lady called Aunt Merinda. She delivered the babies and doctored the sick as best she could.⁹

Another child was born to Sarah on November 15, 1892. They named him Owen. Sarah was 34 years old and Henry was 68. This baby was Sarah's seventh child and Henry's twenty-fifth. By the end of 1892 Henry had twenty-seven grandchildren.

The little community of Pacheco was very isolated from civilization. There was no mail service nearer than Colonia Juarez, and that was only bi-weekly. For many years they were also isolated

from the Mexicans and felt that this was an advantage. The natives were afraid of the mountains because they had been a stronghold for the notorious Apache Chief, Geronimo, and his followers until the United States, through a special treaty with the Mexican government, sent in soldiers who captured and banished the Indians to Florida. From the time when the Mormons first settled in the Sierra Madres, there had only been Indian signs now and then in various locations. They had never had any real skirmishes until the fall of 1892. Three prospectors were run out of their camp by marauding Apache Indians, barely escaping with their lives. Then, the country was thrown into a panic when a family by the names of Thompson was massacred on September 19, 1892. They lived about ten miles from Pacheco in the Peadras Verde Rio area. Thomas recorded the following:

It was on a Monday and Mr. Thompson had only left the previous day for Pacheco where he was working on the thresher. The two boys, Hyrum and Elmer, were on their way to the nearby field to work when a shot suddenly rang out and Hyrum fell dead. Elmer looked quickly around and saw some Indians near the house but before he had time to move, he was shot also, the bullet piercing his right lung, and he fell as though dead. The mother ran out at the sound of the shooting and she, too, was shot. She leaned against the house and a squaw ran up and dragged her to the ground and dropped a large rock on her head. Elmer, who had been wounded, crawled into a nearby chicken coop. He saw his little sister, a girl of about six, run out of the house and, when she saw what they had done to her mother, she began hitting them with her fists. They evidently intended to kidnap her, as they left her unharmed and went into the house to ransack it. Elmer got the child's attention and beckoned her to him. When the Indians came out and began looking for the child, they noticed that the boy, too, was gone and not knowing whether the children

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had gone to spread an alarm, they made a hasty get-away. They came very near finding them as one of the long-haired ones came almost to the coop, and then turned away.

The two children started up the road for help but the boy fainted from loss of blood. The little girl ran to the stream and, cupping her hands, carried water until he revived. She left him under a tree and ran on alone. Soon she met a horseman and the news was quickly spread. Kind friends from Cave Valley, four miles away, took care of the dead and administered to Elmer. A posse of men went in pursuit of the Indians but were not able to catch up to them. Following this tragedy every man carried a gun, even to church. They built a stockade around the log school house. Thomas wrote that "years later the Indians met their retribution when they ran in front of the guns of Martin Harris and Thomas Allen in the autumn of 1900 when they caught them stealing their corn." Thomas indicated that this story was told to him by Elmer after he recovered.

Another incident that saddened the settlement, earlier in the summer of 1892, was the death of Hyrum Naegle who was killed by a wounded bear.

In the spring of 1893 Henry traveled to Salt Lake City, Utah for the dedication of the Salt Lake Temple on April 6. The temple was dedicated by President Wilford Woodruff. This was exactly forty years, even to the date, from the time he went with Ellen and witnessed the laying of the cornerstones of the foundation. While there, Henry went through the temple and put little Alma's name on the prayer roll. Alma had been tongue-tied since birth and, even though the doctor in Deming had "clipped" his tongue, he could not speak until about the time Henry went to the temple.¹⁰

The newspaper, *Chicago Tribune*, printed that the Salt Lake Temple was worth a trip across the continent to see. Also, the temple structure is built with gray Wasatch granite, and the interior "is finer than Solomon's Temple." The size of the edifice is 186 feet by 99 feet and the highest spire supports the figure of the Mormon Angel Moroni. In the Salt Lake City newspaper, *The Tribune*, it was stated:

"To control relic seekers who were attempting to chip off pieces of the structure, and to prevent individuals from scratching their names on the walls, the Mormon officials issued special tickets."

Henry stopped in Cedar City for about six weeks and stayed with his second wife, Mary Ann, and visited with his family and friends. He must have had misgivings about leaving again for Mexico, even though he knew he was needed there. While in Cedar City he gave Florence, a daughter, a Patriarchal Blessing as well as a Father's Blessing. Henry traveled to St. George on May 30, 1893, to attend the temple. Most likely, Mary Ann went with him. There are records of him being in the St. George Temple where he had twelve women sealed to him, among which was a sister of Sarah's, Mary Ann Lunt, who died at age four. Another of the women was Martha Bristol, his early sweetheart in England. The others were: Ann Elsmore, Mary Risley, Fanny Dickenson, Frances Emma Kirkbridge, Anne Willett, Fanny Johnson, Mary Ellen Hopkins, Esther Ann Porter, Annie Singleton, and Ada Owen Lunt.¹¹

Henry left in June for Milford, Utah, which was the location of the railroad terminal. The train went from Milford to Salt Lake, Denver, Colorado and south to Deming. He made a stop in Nephi on the way and visited with Sarah Ann's family. He wrote a letter to Mary Ann from Salt Lake City on July 4, 1893 as follows:

Dear Mary Ann: Yours of the first instance just received with the letter from Ellen enclosed. I received the half fare ticket all right at Milford. Arrived at Nephi on Friday evening, found old Brother Lunt [Sarah's father] quite well, but the old lady not quite so well but able to go with me around to all the folks. Thought of going to Salt Lake next day, but President Paxman was very anxious I should stay over Sunday. Attended the monthly Priesthood meeting on Saturday Morning in the Tabernacle and the High Priests meeting in the afternoon and Sunday School on Sunday morning. A very large congregation assembled in the Tabernacle to hear from their

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Mexican visitor. We had an unusually good meeting, the weather was very hot and I don't think I ever got such a warming up in preaching in all my life--I was like a boiled cabbage with perspiration.

Brother and Sister Lunt accompanied me to the station at Nephi. Willard [Burt, a son-in-law married to Jane Gower Lunt who was the oldest child of Henry and Annie] met me at the station here [Salt Lake City] and got aboard the electric cars and were soon at the house met by Janie [Jane Lunt Burt] and children. It is a frame house and so hot I slept in the backyard on a spring bed, and could hardly sleep at all through a racket of firecrackers and other fire works, some of which made a terrific report and the noise was kept up all night and increased as daybreak came. There's no formal celebration of the fourth, but a host are going to the Salt Air beach to bathe and witness a balloon ascension. I am staying in the house today, have written a letter to Henry [W.] and am now going to take a bath and put on some clean garments. I intend starting for Deming next Monday. I pray the Lord will bless and preserve me. I hope you will all think of me.

I am not blest with as much means as I would like by a great deal, yet I think I will have enough to get home. I was in hopes of raising enough to pay my debts and buy some flour. The times are getting more hard daily. Mines are closing down all through the country, and thousands of men are thrown out of work. Provo Bank broke on Friday and many business houses are about broke. The unprecedented low price of silver and wool is the cause of much distress and disaster. Hundreds of men here are idle. Remember me to Brother Webster and family. I hope Eva and Jed [Jones] are improving. Give my kindest love to Florence and Herb [Webster] and a kiss for that darling little pet. Love to Willie and Rosa [William

Wilson Lunt, their son, and wife, Rosanna Naegle Lunt], a kiss for Johnny [their baby, 7 months old]--in short, God bless you all.

I guess poor Randle [Mary Ann's fourth child] is as busy as ever this hot weather. Remember me to Kate [Catherine, Randle's wife] and all the dear children. As every yours, and etc. Henry Lunt.¹²

Henry arrived in Deming, New Mexico on Friday, July 14, 1893. He wrote the following letter to Mary Ann [in Cedar City] from Deming two days later, September 16:

Dear Mary Ann: In haste I drop you a few lines. I started from Salt Lake on Tuesday evening at 7:20 from the D&RG [Denver and Rio Grande] Railway Depot, changed cars at Grand Junction on the Colorado Midland to Colorado Springs. Changed cars again on the Atchison, Topeka and Santa Fe system and arrived at Deming, 12:30 noon on Friday. Sarah, Edgerton, Rachel, Alma and baby [Owen] arrived from Pacheco in the evening, the team very poor and jaded and one mare quite lame. We are staying in a camp house and feedyard, by no means the cleanest of a place. The weather very uncomfortably warm. It's 3 o'clock Sunday afternoon. Boxes, or anything else we can improvise for seats, are made use of for seats in the absence of chairs. Thermometer, 98 degrees in the shade. Light thunder shower yesterday. Expect to start for Pacheco on Tuesday or Wednesday. Shall be glad to reach the mountains and breathe the cool and invigorating air. A great cry here, as elsewhere, of hard times. Elder M. F. Trejo accompanied me from Salt Lake the most of the way, and, at the Rincon Junction, took the El Paso train to meet A. F. McDonald, who are both going to the city of Mexico in the interest of our Mexican Colonies and expect to

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have an interview with President Diaz. Brother Trejo is a smart and interesting man. We enjoyed ourselves on the way very much and very reluctantly parted. He is a native of Spain--joined the church some 14 years ago in Salt Lake City. He is a scholar and a mineralogist and claims to be a literal descendant of the royal family of Spain. He, it was who translated the Book of Mormon into Spanish. He goes with Brother McDonald as interpreter. I found Brother McDonald here on my arrival. We had a good visit; I saw him off yesterday by train for El Paso to join Brother Trejo. A man has got to travel to see and learn of what the world of mankind is missing. I had very agreeable and interesting conversations with gentlemen on the train from New York, Chicago, San Francisco, and other points. They are all of the opinion that a great crisis is at hand if times keep as they are for 3 months longer. Babylon is certainly getting very shaky. President Woodruff said to me that he never saw such times in all his life, he and Joseph F. and I had a private talk together.

I presented the 100 dollar certificate of stock in the Deseret Telegraph Company, as I was anxious to know if they could give me anything for it to help me on my way home. They called on James Jack, and he reported not a dollar on hand. The clerk in the office told me they couldn't get their pay as there was no money on hand. President G. Q. Cannon is in London and Heber J. Grant in New York. Bishop W. D. Johnson Jr. of Diaz left here last week for London to see John W. Young, in the interest of John W. Young's great Mexican Railroad which has so far proved a failure, to the great injury of a number of our brethren who did grading 2 years ago and haven't yet got their pay. An old friend, Elias Morris, told me he was in a tight place financially and, I assure you, he is

not the only one.

Sarah brings me word that our two mares each had a fine colt, one was killed by the mountain lions and the other drowned in the river. Such is life--as the sparks fly upward, so is man born to trouble. It's an easy thing to acknowledge the hand of God in prosperity, but Job did in affliction and adversity, and L.D. Saints should do the same. An old friend, Joseph Fish, has left Holbrook Co-op Store in Snowflake Stake and gone to Sonora in Mexico, thus fulfilling my words to him four years ago when he didn't believe a word of it.

I didn't ask any counsel from President Woodruff, and he didn't volunteer any to me, but blessed me very heartily twice over. You can read this to our beloved brethren Webster and Heybourne. If I had not sold the little capitol stock of Annie and Aunt Ellen's, I should have been in a tight place to have got home.

What became of the candy I saved in Cedar to fetch home with me for the children? It could not have been put in my valise. Love to you all. How's Eva's health and Jed's? God bless you all. Remember me to Brother Leigh and Henrietta and, in short, all my dear old friends. Henry Lunt.

The Durfee family lived in Pacheco and were well-acquainted with the Lunts. In the spring of 1893 Edmond F. Durfee, the father of the family, rented land in Pacheco and planted crops which turned out to be a failure because of the weather conditions. He cut the corn for feed and went to Colonia Juarez to look for work. His family had been living on corn bread, and very little of that. They had no flour. Durfee got a job on a thrasher and was away from home during Christmas. He wrote in his diary about an experience his wife had while he was away, in her words:

December 25, 1893, Christmas morning, a tap

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came on my door and I opened it. I saw Patriarch Henry Lunt on a horse. He was well wrapped for it was early and very cold; he asked if Brother Durfee was in. I answered, 'He is in the valley trying to get or earn some flour.' I insisted on him coming in but he said, 'No, dear sister, I have come with a message from the Lord to him [Durfee]. Why, bless your heart, I had no idea of the hunger and suffering you have endured, until the Lord showed it all to me last night, and I have walked the floor, waiting for daylight, that I might come and deliver the blessing the Lord promised you. Tell Brother Durfee that the Lord is pleased with him in the way he has shared his scanty portion with others. Get in a good lot of seed, plant every foot of land he can, every hill of corn, squash, potatoes and beans he can, for the Lord is going to give him a bounteous harvest. Help him all you can, and I bring you the promise that you shall never suffer for food, neither you nor your animals, in the future, as you have in the past; and you shall be able to pay all obligations.'

As soon as my husband came I told him and did all I could to help plant the seeds and rejoice in the blessing, and [we] had faith it would be fulfilled.¹³

According to Durfee: "While working I was successful in earning wheat and took it to the mill and went home rejoicing with flour for my family. When I reached home and heard of the blessing promised, I did as I was bid." He wrote:

June 28, 1894, came the first showing of rain and the crops were growing good. That fall we had a bounteous harvest. When the plow ran down the rows of potatoes the ground was nearly covered with large white potatoes, our crop being over four hundred bushels, and we sold them all for 4 cents a pound,

except what we kept for seed and enough for our family needs. We paid off all our debts and obligations! I testify that the promise was fulfilled!"

1. Thomas C. Romney, *Mormon Colonies in Mexico*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Deseret Book Co., 1938), p. 108.
2. L. W. Macfarlane, *John M. Macfarlane*, (Salt Lake City, Utah; Published by L. W. Macfarlane, 1981), p. 248.
3. Thomas A. Lunt, "Thomas A. Lunt History," 1941, Zina Lunt Rigby, Cedar City, Utah, p. 131.
4. Matthias F. Cowley, *Wilford Woodruff*, (Salt Lake City, Utah: Book Craft, 1964), p. 566.
5. *Ibid.*, p. 570.
6. L. W. Macfarlane, *op. cit.*, p. 267.
7. Broughton Lunt, "History of Sarah Ann Lunt," 1946, From Sylvia L. Heywood, Phoenix, Az and Sarah Lunt McGuire, Silver City, New Mexico files, p. 9.
8. *Ibid.*, p. 7.
9. Fern Bauer, "Life History of Ellen Lunt Chatterly," Cliff and Lillian Chatterley File, Cedar City, Utah, p. 1.
10. Marza Lunt Hatch, "Life Story of Alma Lunt," From Vefa Lunt Olsen File, Orem, Utah, p. 1.
11. Garth Chatterley, "Lunt Generation File", Cedar City, Utah, St. George Temple Record Book, "F," p. 147.
12. Henry Lunt, "Letter --July 4, 1893," Original letter in possession of York and Evelyn Jones, Cedar City, Utah.
13. Hatch & Hardy, *Stalwards South of The Border*, "Christmas In Pacheco," December 25, 1893.